ablaut in the singular, but the weak grade in the dual and plural. Thus for example the singular and plural of the verbs for '*to be*', and '*to go*' were: ***és-mi, *és-si, *és-ti, *s-més** or ***s-mós, *s-té, *s-énti**; ***éi-mi, *éi-si, *éi-ti, *i-més** or ***i-mós, *i-té, *j-énti.** Verbs of this class are often called **mi**-verbs because the first person singular ends in **-mi.** The Germanic languages have only preserved a few traces of the **mi**-conjugation (§ **547**). Nearly all the verbal forms, which originally belonged to this class, passed over into the **ō**-conjugation in the prim. Germanic period.

In the thematic verbs the stem-vowel, which could be either of the strong or weak grade of ablaut, remained unchanged throughout the present; in the former case they are called imperfect presents (as **cēosan,** *to choose*; **helpan,** *to help*; **etan,** *to eat*; &c.), and in the latter case aorist presents (as OE. **lūcan,** *to close*; **murnan,** *to mourn*; &c.). The present was formed by means of the thematic vowels, **e, o,** which came between the root and the personal endings, thus the present singular and plural of the verb for '*to bear*' was ***bhérō** (from ***bhér-o-a**), ***bhér-e-si, *bhér-e-ti, *bhér-o-mes,** (**-mos**), ***bhér-e-te, *bhér-o-nti.** Verbs of this class are generally called **ō**-verbs because the first person singular ends in **-ō.** The old distinction between the **mi-** and the **ō**-conjugation was fairly well preserved in Greek, as εἰμί, *I am,* εἶμι, *I go,* δίδωμι, *I give*; μένω, *I remain,* πείθω, *I persuade*; τρίβω, *I rub,* τύφω, *I smoke.*

§ **473.** In treating the history of the verbal forms in OE. it is advisable to start out partly from prim. Germanic and partly from the oldest OE. The Indg. verbal system underwent so many radical changes in prim. Germanic that it would be necessary to treat here in detail the verbal system of the non-Germanic languages such as Sanskrit, Greek, and Latin in order to account for all the changes.

In the Germanic languages the verbs are divided into two great classes:—Strong and Weak. The strong verbs form their preterite (originally perfect) and past participle by means of ablaut (§ **224**). The weak verbs form their preterite by the addition of a syllable containing a dental (Goth. **-da, (-ta)**, OE. **-de, -te**), and their past participle by means of a dental suffix (Goth. **-þ, (-t)**, OE. **-d, (-t)**).

Besides these two great classes of strong and weak verbs, there are a few others which will be treated under the general heading of *Minor Groups.*

The strong verbs were originally further sub-divided into reduplicated and non-reduplicated verbs, as Goth. **haldan,** *to hold,* **lētan,** *to let,* preterite **haíhald, laílōt; niman,** *to take,* **hilpan,** *to help,* preterite **nam, halp.** In OE. the reduplication almost entirely disappeared in the prehistoric period of the language (§ **511**). The non-reduplicated verbs are divided into six classes according to the six ablaut-series (§ **226**). The originally reduplicated verbs are put together in this book and called class VII.

§ **474.** The OE. verb has the following independent forms:—one voice (active), two numbers, three persons, two tenses (present and preterite), two complete moods (indicative, and subjunctive, the latter originally the optative), besides an imperative which is only used in the present tense; two verbal nouns (present infinitive and present participle), and one verbal adjective (the past participle).

The simple future was generally expressed by the present tense as in the oldest periods of the other Germanic languages, but already in OE. the present forms of **bēon,** *to be,* **sculan,** *shall,* **willan,** *will,* with the infinitive began to be used to express the future. In the oldest OE. the perfect of transitive verbs was formed by means of the forms of **habban,** *to have,* and the past participle, and that of intransitive verbs by means of **wesan,** *to be,* and the past

participle. At a later period **habban** came to be used to form the perfect of intransitive verbs also. The only trace of the old passive voice preserved in OE. is **hātte** (Goth. **háitada**), *is* or *was called*, pl. **hātton.** Otherwise the passive was expressed by the forms of **bēon, wesan,** *to be*, occasionally also **weorþan,** *to become*, and the past participle.

A. Strong Verbs.

§ **475.** We are able to conjugate a strong verb in OE. when we know the four stems, as seen (1) in the infinitive or first pers. sing. pres. indicative, (2) first pers. sing. pret. indicative, (3) first pers. pl. pret. indicative, (4) the past participle. The pret. subjunctive and the second pers. pret. indicative have the same stem-vowel as the pret. pl. indicative. The conjugation of **beran,** *to bear*, **helpan,** *to help*, **bindan,** *to bind*, **rīdan,** *to ride*, **cēosan,** *to choose*, **weorpan,** *to throw*, **faran,** *to go*, **biddan,** *to pray*, **feallan,** *to fall*, **tēon,** *to draw*, **slēan,** *to slay*, **fōn,** *to seize*, will serve as models for all strong verbs, because in addition to verbal endings, one or other of them illustrates such phenomena as umlaut, the interchange between **i** and **e** in the pres. indic. of verbs belonging to classes III, IV, and V, breaking, vowel contraction, vowel syncope, the simplification of double consonants, Verner's law, and the consonant changes in the second and third pers. sing. of the pres. indicative.

Present.

Indicative.

Sing.	1.	**bere**	**helpe**	**binde**	**rīde**
	2.	**bir(e)st**	**hilpst**	**bintst**	**rītst**
	3.	**bir(e)þ**	**hilpþ**	**bint**	**rīt(t)**
Plur.		**beraþ**	**helpaþ**	**bindaþ**	**rīdaþ**

Subjunctive.

Sing.	bere	helpe	binde	rīde
Plur.	beren	helpen	binden	rīden

Imperative.

Sing. 2.	ber	help	bind	rīd
Plur. 2.	beraþ	helpaþ	bindaþ	rīdaþ

Infinitive.

beran	helpan	bindan	rīdan

Participle.

berende	helpende	bindende	rīdende

Preterite.

Indicative.

Sing. 1.	bær	healp	band	rād
2.	bǣre	hulpe	bunde	ride
3.	bær	healp	band	rād
Plur.	bǣron	hulpon	bundon	ridon

Subjunctive.

Sing.	bǣre	hulpe	bunde	ride
Plur.	bǣren	hulpen	bunden	riden

Participle.

boren	holpen	bunden	riden

Present.

Indicative.

Sing. 1.	cēose	weorpe	fare	bidde
2.	cīest	wierpst	fær(e)st	bitst
3.	cīest	wierpþ	fær(e)þ	bit(t)
Plur.	cēosaþ	weorpaþ	faraþ	biddaþ

Subjunctive.

Sing.	cēose	weorpe	fare	bidde
Plur.	cēosen	weorpen	faren	bidden

Imperative.

Sing. 2.	cēos	weorp	far	bide
Plur. 2.	cēosaþ	weorpaþ	faraþ	biddaþ

Infinitive.

cēosan	weorpan	faran	biddan

Participle.

cēosende	weorpende	farende	biddende

Preterite.

Indicative.

Sing. 1.	cēas	wearp	fōr	bæd
2.	cure	wurpe	fōre	bǣde
3.	cēas	wearp	fōr	bæd
Plur.	curon	wurpon	fōron	bǣdon

Subjunctive.

Sing.	cure	wurpe	fōre	bǣde
Plur.	curen	wurpen	fōren	bǣden

Participle.

coren	worpen	faren	beden

Present.

Indicative.

Sing. 1.	fealle	tēo	slēa	fō
2.	fielst	tīehst	sliehst	fēhst
3.	fielþ	tīehþ	sliehþ	fēhþ
Plur.	feallaþ	tēoþ	slēaþ	fōþ

Subjunctive.

Sing.	fealle	tēo	slēa	fō
Plur.	feallen	tēon	slēan	fōn

Imperative.

Sing. 2.	**feall**	**tēoh**	**sleah**	**fōh**
Plur. 2.	**feallaþ**	**tēoþ**	**slēaþ**	**fōþ**

Infinitive.

feallan	**tēon**	**slēan**	**fōn**

Participle.

feallende	**tēonde**	**slēande**	**fōnde**

Preterite.

Indicative.

Sing. 1.	**fēoll**	**tēah**	**slōh, slōg**	**fēng**
2.	**fēolle**	**tuge**	**slōge**	**fēnge**
3.	**fēoll**	**tēah**	**slōh, slōg**	**fēng**
Plur.	**fēollon**	**tugon**	**slōgon**	**fēngon**

Subjunctive.

Sing.	**fēolle**	**tuge**	**slōge**	**fēnge**
Plur.	**fēollen**	**tugen**	**slōgen**	**fēngen**

Participle.

feallen	**togen**	**slægen**	**fangen**

The Endings of Strong Verbs.

§ **476.** Pres. indicative: The Indg. and prim. Germanic ending of the first pers. sing. was **-ō** (cp. Lat. **ferō**, Gr. **φέρω**, Indg. ***bhérō**, *I bear*) which became **-u** (later **-o**) in prim. OE. (§ **214**). The **-u** (**-o**) regularly remained after short stems and disappeared after long stems, as **beru**, **-o** beside ***help**, ***bind** (§ **215**), but already in prehistoric OE. the verbs with long stems took **-u** again after the analogy of those with short stems. The Anglian dialect mostly preserved the **-u** (**-o**), but in early WS. and Ken. its place was taken by **-e** from the pres. subjunctive.

The prim. Germanic forms of the second pers. sing. of **beran** and **bindan** were ***þirizi, *þinđizi** = Indg. ***bhéresi, *bhéndhesi,** which would regularly have become ***bire** (older ***biri**), ***bind** in OE. (§§ **211, 215**), but already in prehistoric OE. the second pers. sing. of strong verbs was remodelled on the analogy of the first class of weak verbs which did not have the chief accent on the stem in prim. Germanic (§ **239**, Note 2). The oldest OE. forms were **biris, bindis** which regularly became later **bires, bindes** (§ **215**, Note). The ending **-st** arose partly from analogy with the preterite-present forms **wāst, þearft, scealt,** &c. and partly from a false etymological division of the pronoun from the verb to which it was often attached enclitically, thus **birisþu** became **biristu,** from which **birist** was extracted as the verbal form, cp. the similar process in OHG. The ending **-st** occurs earliest in the contracted verbs, **tīehst, sliehst,** &c.

The prim. Germanic forms of the third pers. sing. of **beran** and **bindan** were ***þiriđi** (= OS. **birid,** OHG. **birit**), ***þinđiđi** = Indg. ***bhéreti, *bhéndheti,** which would regularly have become ***bired,** older ***birid,** and ***bind(d)** in OE., but already in prehistoric OE. the third pers. sing. like the second was remodelled on analogy with the first class of weak verbs. The oldest OE. forms were **biriþ, bindiþ,** later **bir(e)þ, bint** (§ **300**). The **-eþ** became **-es** in late Nth.

In the second and third pers. sing. the **-i-** (**-e-**) was regularly syncopated after long stems, as **hilpst, hilpþ, rītst, rīt(t), tīehst, tīehþ,** &c., and remained after short stems, as **birest, bireþ, færest, færeþ,** &c. (§ **221**), but there are many exceptions to this rule, especially in WS. and Ken., owing to new formations in both directions, as **bindest, bindeþ, hilpest, hilpeþ,** &c., and on the other hand **birst, birþ, færst, færþ,** &c. In Anglian the forms without syncope were almost entirely generalized, but in

WS. and Ken. syncope was almost quite general, especially after voiceless consonants and after **d**, **f** (= **ƀ**), and **g**, but as a rule not after a single liquid or a nasal.

The loss of **·e·** in the second and third pers. sing. gave rise to various consonantal changes: Double consonants were simplified before the personal endings (§ **259**), as **fielst, fielþ, spinst, spinþ,** beside inf. **feallan, spinnan.**

d became **t** before **·st,** as **bintst, bitst, rītst, wieltst** beside **wealdan,** *to wield.* **d** and **t**+**·þ** became **tt** (common in the older period), later **t,** as **bint, bit(t), rīt(t); birst, it(t),** beside inf. **berstan,** *to burst,* **etan,** *to eat,* see § **300.** Forms like **bindest, bidst, wieldst; bindeþ, bid(e)þ,** &c. were new formations after the analogy of forms which regularly had **d.**

After a long vowel, diphthong, or liquid, **g** became **h** before **·st, ·þ** (§ **320,** Note), as **stīhst, stīhþ,** inf. **stīgan,** *to ascend,* **flīehst, flīehþ,** inf. **flēogan,** *to fly,* **swilhst, swilhþ,** inf. **swelgan,** *to swallow,* but the **g** was often restored from forms which regularly had **g.**

s, ss, st+**·st, ·þ** became **·st** (§§ **259, 305**), as **cīest; cyst** beside inf. wv. **cyssan,** *to kiss,* **birst** beside **birstest, birsteþ** (new formations); **x** (= **hs**)+**·st, ·þ** became **xt,** as **wiext** beside inf. **weaxan,** *to grow.* In verbs of this type the second and third pers. singular regularly fell together.

þ disappeared before **·st** (§ **305**), as **cwist, wierst,** beside inf. **cweþan,** *to say,* **weorþan,** *to become.* Forms like **cwiþst, wierþst, snīþst** (inf. **snīþan,** *to cut*), were new formations after the analogy of the other forms of the present. **þ**+**·þ** became **þ,** as **cwiþ, wierþ.**

The forms of the first and second pers. plural had disappeared already in the oldest period of the language, their place having been taken by the form of the third person. The prim. Germanic forms of the third pers. pl. of **beran, bindan** were ***ƀeranđi, *ƀinđanđi** = Indg. ***bhéronti, *bhéndhonti,** which would regularly have

become in OE. ***berand, *bindand** = Goth. **baírand, bindand,** but, as in the second and third pers. singular, the third pers. pl. was remodelled on analogy with the first class of weak verbs which regularly had **·ánþi** in prim. Germanic. **·ánþi** became **·aþ** in OE. through the intermediate stages **·anþ, ·onþ, ·ōþ** (§ **218**). **·aþ** became **·as** in late Nth. This **·s** plural has been preserved in the Modern northern dialects when the subject is not a simple personal pronoun placed immediately before or after the verb.

§ **477.** Pres. subjunctive: This tense is properly an old optative. The original forms of the singular and plural of **beran** were ***bhéroi·, *bhérois, *bhéroit, *bhéroim·, *bhéroite, *bhéroint.** The final **·t** was regularly dropped in prim. Germanic (§ **211**) and the **oi** became **ai** during the same period (§ **30**). Then **ai** became **ǣ** which was shortened to **æ** (§ **217**). The **æ** was preserved in the oldest period of the language and afterwards became **e.** In OE. the original forms of the singular regularly fell together in **bere.** The old forms of the first and second pers. plural disappeared and their place was taken by the third pers. **beren.** Beside **·en** there also occurs in late WS. **·an,** and also **·un, ·on** taken over from the pret. pl. indicative. On the loss of final **·n** in Nth., see § **288.** The final **·n** also disappeared in WS. and Ken. when a personal pronoun of the first or second person came immediately after the verb, as **bere wĕ, wit, gĕ, git.** Then **bere wĕ,** &c., came to be used also for the indicative and imperative.

§ **478.** Imperative: The original ending of the second pers. sing. was **·e** which regularly disappeared without leaving any trace of its former existence (§ **213**), whence OE. **ber** = Gr. φέρε, Indg. ***bhére.** On the **·e** in **bide** beside its absence in **ber, bind,** &c., see § **273.** In OE. the third pers. plural of the pres. indicative was used for the second pers. plural. A form in **·an,** as **beran, bindan,** was occasionally used in the oldest period of the language for

the first pers. plural. This form was originally identical with the first pers. pl. pres. indic. which disappeared in OE. The first pers. pl. is generally expressed by the pres. subjunctive, as **beren, binden,** &c.

§ **479.** Pres. participle: In the parent language the stem of the pres. participle ended in **-nt,** as in Lat. **ferent-,** Gr. φέροντ-, Indg. ***bhéront-** = OE. **berend-e,** Goth. **baírand-s.** The masc. and neut. were originally declined like consonant stems (§ **416**). The fem. nom. sing. originally ended in **-ī** which was shortened to **-i** (§ **214**) in prehistoric OE., cp. Goth. fem. **frijōndi,** *friend.* The **-i** of the feminine was extended to the masc. and neut. which was the cause of their passing over into the **ja-**declension (§ **433**). See § **441.** The oldest OE. ending is **-ændi, -endi,** later **-ende.**

§ **480.** Infinitive: The inf. was originally a nomen actionis, formed by means of various suffixes in the different Indg. languages. The suffix **-ono-,** to which was added the nom. acc. neuter ending **-m,** became generalized in prim. Germanic, thus the original form of **beran** was ***bhéronom,** the **-onom** of which regularly became **-an** in OE. Goth. OS. and OHG. On the loss of the final **-n** in Nth., see § **288.** In prim. West Germanic the inf. was inflected in the gen. and dat. like an ordinary noun of the **ja-**declension (§ **355**), gen. **-ennes,** dat. **-enne.** The inflected forms of the inf. are sometimes called the gerund. The gen. disappeared in prehistoric OE. The dat. **tō berenne** generally became **-anne** through the influence of the inf. ending **-an.** Beside **-enne, -anne** there also occur in late OE. **-ene, -ane,** and **-ende** with **d** from the present participle.

§ **481.** Pret. indicative: The pret. indic. is morphologically an old perfect, which already in prim. Germanic was chiefly used to express the past tense. The original endings of the perf. singular were **-a, -tha, -e,** cp. Gr. οἶδα, οἶσθα, οἶδε. The **-a** and **-e** regularly disappeared in pre-

historic OE. (§§ **212–13**), whence OE. first and third pers. singular **bær, band,** &c. The ending of the second pers. singular would regularly have become **·þ** (§ **233**) in OE. OS. O.Icel. and Goth., except after prim. Germanic **s, f, h** where it regularly became **t** (§ **231,** Notes), as in Goth. **last,** *thou didst gather,* **slōht,** *thou didst slay,* **þarft** (OE. **þearfȣ**), *thou needest.* This **·t** became generalized in prim. Germanic, as Goth. O.Icel. **namt,** *thou tookest.* But in the West Germanic languages the old ending was only preserved in the preterite-present verbs, as OE. **þearft,** *thou needest,* **scealt,** *thou shalt,* **meaht,** *thou mayest,* &c. See § **539** ff. The third pers. plural ended in the parent language in **·nt** (with vocalic **n**) which regularly became **·un** in prim. Germanic (§§ **35, 211**). **·un** remained in the oldest OE. and then later became **·on,** and in late OE. **·an** beside **·on** occurs, whence **bǣron, bundon,** &c.

§ **482.** Pret. subjunctive: The original endings were: singular **·jēm, ·jēs, ·jēt,** plural **·īm, ·īte, ·īnt,** consisting of the optative element **·jē-,** (**·ī-**) and the personal endings. Already in prim. Germanic the **·ī-** of the plural was levelled out into the singular. The new sing. endings **·īm, ·īs, ·īt** would regularly have become **·i** (§§ **214, 218**) in the oldest OE. The **·i** would have caused umlaut in the stem-syllable and then have disappeared after long stems and have remained (later **·e**) after short stems. Regular forms would have been ***bynd, *hylp, *fēr,** &c., but ***cyre, *tyge,** &c. The pl. ending **·īnt** would regularly have become **·in** (later **·en**) with umlaut in the stem-syllable, as ***bynden, *cyren,** &c. But real old pret. subjunctive forms have only been preserved in OE. in a few isolated instances as in the preterite-presents, **dyge, scyle, þyrfe.** In OE. the old endings of the pres. subjunctive came to be used for the preterite some time before the operation of **i-** umlaut. This accounts for the absence of umlaut in the pret. subjunctive in OE., as **bunde, bunden,** &c. Already

in early OE. the pret. subjunctive began to take the endings of the pret. indicative. On the loss of the final **·n** in Nth., see § **288.** The final **·n** also disappeared in WS. and Ken. when a personal pronoun of the first or second person came immediately after the verb, as **bǣre wĕ, wit, gĕ, git.** Then later **bǣre wĕ,** &c., came to be used also for the indicative.

§ **483.** Past participle: The past participle was formed in various ways in the parent language. In prim. Germanic the suffix **·éno·, ·óno·** became restricted to strong verbs, and the suffix **·tó·** to weak verbs. In the strong verbs OE. and O.Icel. generalized the form **·éno·,** and Goth. OS. and OHG. the form **·óno·.** Beside the suffix **·éno·, ·óno·** there also existed in prim. Germanic **·ini·** = Indg. **·éni·** which was preserved in a few OE. past participles with umlaut in the stem-syllable, see § **442.** Prim. Germanic **·énaz, ·íniz** = Indg. **·énos, ·énis** regularly fell together in **·en** in OE., but they were still kept apart in the oldest period of the language, the former being **·æn** (**·en**) and the latter **·in.**

General Remarks on the Strong Verbs.

§ **484.** Present indicative: On the interchange between **i** in the second and third pers. sing. and **e** in the other forms of the present in verbs belonging to classes III, IV, and V, as **hilpst, hilþ: helpan,** *to help*; **bir(e)st, bir(e)þ: beran,** *to bear*; **cwist, cwiþ: cweþan,** *to say,* see § **41.** **i**-umlaut took place in the second and third pers. sing. of all verbs containing a vowel or diphthong capable of being umlauted. On the **i**-umlaut in verbs of class VI, as **fær(e)st, fær(e)þ,** see § **55,** Note 2. On the Anglian forms of the second and third pers. sing. of verbs like **cēosan, tēon,** see § **138.** The regular forms of the second and third pers. sing. were often remodelled on analogy with

the other forms of the present, especially in the Anglian dialect, as **help(e)st, help(e)þ; fealst, fealþ, feallest, fealleþ; weorpest, weorpeþ,** beside older **hilpst, hilpþ; fielst, fielþ; wierpst, wierpþ.**

On **u-** or **o/a-**umlaut of **a, e** in the first pers. sing., and the pl. in the non-WS. dialects, see § **48.** On the breaking of Germanic **a** to **ea,** as in **feallan, healp, wearp,** and of **e** to **eo,** as in **weorpan,** see § **49.** On the vowel contraction in the present of the contracted verbs, see § **139.**

Strong verbs like **biddan,** *to pray,* **hliehhan,** *to laugh,* **licgan,** *to lie down,* **sittan,** *to sit,* had single medial consonants in the second and third pers. sing., because the **j,** which caused the doubling of the consonants in the other forms of the present, had disappeared before the West Germanic doubling of consonants took place, whence **bitst, bit(t); hliehst, hliehþ; lig(e)st, lig(e)þ; sitst, sit(t).**

§ **485.** Infinitive: On the **o/a-**umlaut in the non-WS. dialects, see § **48.**

§ **486.** Pret. indicative: The West Germanic languages only preserved the old pret. (originally perfect) of the second pers. sing. in the preterite-present verbs (see §§ **481, 539**). In all other strong verbs the OE. second pers. sing. was formed direct from the pret. subjunctive, which accounts for the absence of **i-**umlaut in the stem-syllable and the preservation of the final **-e** after both short and long stems, as **ride, cure,** &c., and **bǣre, hulpe, bunde,** &c. The regular forms would have been **ride,** ***cyre,** and ***bǣr,** ***hylp,** ***bynd.**

On the question of **u-**umlaut in the plural of verbs belonging to class I, see § **101.**

§ **487.** Pret. subjunctive: If the OE. pret. subjunctive had been normally developed from the corresponding prim. Germanic forms, it would have had **i-**umlaut in the stem-syllable as in O. Icelandic. But this tense took the endings of the pres. subjunctive in the prehistoric period

of the language before the operation of **i**-umlaut. See § **482.**

§ **488.** Past Participle: The ending of the past participle has already been explained in § **442.** In prim. Germanic the prefix *ǯi- was added to the past participle to impart to it a perfective meaning. Verbs which were already perfective in meaning, such as **bringan,** *to bring,* **cuman,** *to come,* **findan,** *to find,* **niman,** *to take,* **weorþan,** *to become,* did not originally have it. But in OE. the simple past participle generally had **ge-,** irrespectively as to whether it was perfective or imperfective in meaning. On past participles which have **i**-umlaut, see § **442.**

§ **489.** On the parts of strong verbs which exhibit Verner's law in OE., see § **238.**

The Classification of the Strong Verbs.

Class I.

§ **490.** The verbs of this class belong to the first ablaut-series (§ **226**) and therefore have **ī** in all forms of the present, **ā** in the first and third pers. sing. of the preterite, and **i** in the preterite plural and past participle, thus:

bīdan, *to await*	**bād**	**bidon**	**biden**
Goth. **beidan**	**báiþ**	**bidun**	**bidans**

And similarly **ætwītan,** *to blame, reproach*; **ācwīnan,** *to dwindle away*; **behlīdan,** *to cover*; **belīfan,** *to remain*; **bescītan,** *to befoul*; **besmītan,** *to pollute*; **bītan,** *to bite*; **blīcan,** *to shine*; **cīnan,** *to crack*; **clīfan,** *to stick, adhere*; **cnīdan,** *to beat*; **drīfan,** *to drive*; **dwīnan,** *to dwindle*; **flītan,** *to strive, quarrel*; **gewītan,** *to depart*; **gīnan,** *to yawn*; **glīdan,** *to glide*; **gnīdan,** *to rub together*; **grīpan,** *to seize*; **hnītan,** *to knock*; **hrīnan,** *to touch*; **hwīnan,** *to whizz*; **nīpan,** *to grow dark*; **rīdan,** *to ride*; **sīcan,** *to sigh*; **scīnan** (§ **133,** Note 2), *to shine*; **scrīfan,** *to prescribe*; **slīdan,** *to slide*; **slītan,** *to slit*; **snīcan,** *to crawl*; **spīwan** (§ **265**), *to spew, spit*; **strīcan,** *to stroke*; **strīdan,** *to stride*; **swīcan,**

to cease from; **swīfan,** *to sweep*; **tōslīfan,** *to spht*; **þwīnan,** *to grow soft*; **þwītan,** *to hew*; **wīcan,** *to yield, give way*; **wlītan,** *to gaze*; **wrīdan,** *to grow, flourish*; **wrītan,** *to write.* **stīgan,** *to ascend,* pret. sing. **stāg** beside **stāh** (§ **323**); and similarly **hnīgan,** *to incline*; **mīgan,** *to make water*; **sīgan,** *to sink.*

§ **491.** **snīþan,** *to cut* **snāþ** **snidon** **sniden**

And similarly **līþan,** *to go*; **scrīþan,** *to go, proceed.* See § **239.** In **ārīsan,** *to arise*; **gerīsan,** *to befit*; **mīþan,** *to avoid*; **wrīþan,** *to twist,* the **s,** **þ** of the present was extended to all forms of the verb.

§ **492.** **tīon, tēon,** *to accuse* **tāh** **tigon** **tigen**

tīon, tēon, from older ***tīohan,** ***tīhan** (§ **127**); on the **g** in the pret. pl. and past participle, see § **239.** In the pres. the **ēo** from older **īo** regularly fell together with the **ēo** from Germanic **eu** (§ **137**) which was the cause of verbs of this type often forming their preterite and past participle after the analogy of class II (§ **495**), as **tēah, tugon, togen**; and similarly **lēon,** *to lend*; **sēon,** *to strain*; **þēon,** *to thrive*; **wrēon,** *to cover.* **þēon** from prim. Germanic ***þiŋχanan** (§ **41**) originally belonged to class III; the regular principal parts in OE. would have been **þëon,** ***þōh** (§ **40**), **þungon, þungen,** all of which occur except ***þōh.** The regular past participles of **lēon** (Goth. **leihvan**) and **sēon** (prim. Germanic ***sīχwan-**) were ***liwen, siwen** with **w** from prim. Germanic **gw** (§ **241**); **ligen, sigen** were formed on analogy with the other verbs of this type.

CLASS II.

§ **493.** The verbs of this class belong to the second ablaut-series (§ **226**) and therefore have **ēo** in the present, **ēa** in the first and third pers. sing. of the preterite, **u** in the pret. plural, and **o** in the past participle, thus:

bëodan, *to command*	**bēad**	**budon**	**boden**
Goth. **biudan**	**báuþ**	**budun**	**budans**

And similarly **āþrēotan,** *to tire of*; **brēotan,** *to break, destroy*; **clēofan,** *to cleave asunder*; **crēopan,** *to creep*; **drēopan,** *to drip*; **flēotan,** *to flow*; **gēopan,** *to take to oneself*; **gēotan,** *to pour*; **grēotan,** *to weep*; **hlēotan,** *to cast lots*; **lēodan,** *to grow*; **nēotan,** *to use, enjoy*; **rēocan,** *to smoke, reek*; **rēodan,** *to redden*; **rēotan,** *to weep*; **scēotan,** *to shoot*; **smēocan,** *to smoke*; **þēotan,** *to howl.* **drēogan,** *to endure,* pret. sing. **drēag** beside **drēah** (§ **323**); and similarly **flēogan,** *to fly*; **lēogan,** *to tell lies.* **brēowan,** *to brew,* pret. sing. **brēaw** (§ **265**); and similarly **cēowan,** *to chew*; **hrēowan,** *to repent of, rue.*

§ **494.** **cēosan,** *to choose* **cēas** **curon** **coren**

And similarly **drēosan,** *to fall*; **forlēosan,** *to lose*; **frēosan,** *to freeze*; **hrēosan,** *to fall*; **sēoþan** (**sudon, soden**), *to boil.* See § **239.** **ābrēoþan,** *to perish, ruin,* extended the **þ** to all parts of the verb.

§ **495.** **tēon,** *to draw* **tēah** **tugon** **togen**

tēon (Goth. **tiuhan**) from ***tēohan** (§ **139**); on the **g** in the pret. plural and past participle, see § **239**; and similarly **flēon,** *to flee.*

§ **496.** Here belong also the aorist presents with weak grade vowel in all forms of the present (§ **472**).

brūcan, *to use* **brēac** **brucon** **brocen**

And similarly **dūfan,** *to dive*; **hrūtan,** *to snore*; **lūcan,** *to lock*; **lūtan,** *to incline, bow down*; **scūfan,** *to push, shove*; **slūpan,** *to slip*; **sūcan,** *to suck*; **sūpan,** *to sup*; **strūdan,** *to pillage*; **þūtan,** *to howl.* **būgan,** *to bend,* pret. sing. **bēag** beside **bēah** (§ **323**); and similarly **smūgan,** *to creep*; **sūgan,** *to suck.*

Class III.

§ **497.** The verbs of this class belong to the third ablaut-series (§ **226**), and include the strong verbs having a medial nasal or liquid + consonant, and a few others in which the

vowel is followed by two consonants other than a nasal or liquid + consonant.

§ **498.** Verbs with nasal + consonant had **i** in all forms of the present, **a, o** (§ **59**) in the first and third pers. sing. of the preterite, and **u** in the preterite pl. and past participle, thus:

	bindan, *to bind*	**band** (**bond**)	**bundon**	**bunden**
Goth.	**bindan**	**band**	**bundun**	**bundans**

And similarly **ācwincan,** *to vanish*; **climban,** *to climb*; **clingan,** *to shrink*; **crimman,** *to insert*; **crincan, cringan,** *to fall, succumb*; **drincan,** *to drink*; **gelimpan,** *to happen*; **grimman,** *to rage*; **grindan,** *to grind*; **hlimman,** *to resound*; **hrindan,** *to push*; **linnan,** *to cease*; **onginnan,** *to begin*; **rinnan,** *to run, flow*; **scrincan, scringan,** *to shrink*; **sinnan,** *to meditate*; **slincan,** *to slink, creep*; **spinnan,** *to spin*; **springan,** *to leap*; **stincan,** *to stink*; **stingan,** *to sting*; **þindan,** *to swell*; **þringan,** *to throng, press*; **þrintan,** *to swell*; **windan,** *to wind*; **winnan,** *to toil, fight*; **wringan,** *to wring*. On **sincan** (Goth. **sigqan**), *to sink*; **singan** (Goth. **siggwan**), *to sing*; **swincan,** *to toil*; **swindan,** *to disappear*; **swingan,** *to swing*; **swimman,** *to swim*, see § **249.** The regular principal parts of **findan** (Goth. **finþan**) would have been **fīþan** (§ **97**), **fōþ** (§ **64**), **fundon, funden** (§ **239**); the present, and the pret. sing. **fand** were formed on analogy with verbs like **bindan**; beside **fand** there occurs **funde** which is the second pers. sing. also used for the first and third. On **biernan** (Goth. **brinnan**), *to burn*, **barn** (Goth. **brann**), **born** (later **bearn**), **burnon, burnen**; and **iernan** (Goth. **rinnan**, see above), *to run*, **arn** (Goth. **rann**), **orn** (later **earn**), **urnon, urnen**, see § **98**, Note 3.

§ **499.** Verbs with **l** + cons. except **lc** (§ **84**) have **e** in the present, **ea** (§ **64**) in the first and third pers. sing. of the preterite, **u** in the pret. plural, and **o** in the past participle (§ **43**), thus:

	helpan, *to help*	**healp**	**hulpon**	**holpen**
Goth.	**hilpan**	**halp**	**hulpun**	**hulpans**

And similarly **belgan,** *to swell with anger*; **bellan,** *to bellow*; **beteldan,** *to cover*; **delfan,** *to dig*; **meltan,** *to melt*; **swelgan,** *to swallow*; **swellan,** *to swell*; **sweltan** (§ **249**), *to die.* **gieldan** (§ **91**), *to yield,* **geald, guldon, golden**; and similarly **giellan,** *to yell*; **gielpan,** *to boast.*

§ **500.** Verbs with **lc, r** or **h** + consonant have **eo** in the present (§§ **83–6**), **ea** in the first and third pers. sing. of the preterite, **u** in the preterite plural, and **o** in the past participle. On the verbs with the combination **weo** in the present, see § **94.**

weorpan, *to throw*	**wearp**	**wurpon**	**worpen**

And similarly **āseolcan,** *to languish*; **beorcan,** *to bark*; **beorgan,** *to protect*; **ceorfan,** *to cut, carve*; **deorfan,** *to labour*; **hweorfan,** *to turn, go*; **feohtan,** *to fight*; **meolcan,** late WS. also **melcan,** *to milk*; **sceorfan,** *to gnaw*; **sceorpan,** *to scrape*; **steorfan,** *to die*; **sweorfan,** *to rub*; **sweorcan,** *to become dark.* **weorþan,** *to become,* **wearþ, wurdon, worden** (§ **239**).

§ **501.** **fēolan** from ***feolhan** (§ **84,** Note 1), *to enter, penetrate,* **fealh** (§ **64**), **fulgon** (§ **239**) beside the more common form **fǣlon** made after the analogy of verbs of class IV, **folgen**; pret. pl. and pp. also **fūlon** from ***fulhon, fōlen** from ***folhen** with **h** from the pres. ***feolhan.**

§ **502.**

bregdan, *to brandish*	**brægd**	**brugdon**	**brogden**
stregdan, *to strew*	**strægd**	**strugdon**	**strogden**
berstan, *to burst*	**bærst**	**burston**	**borsten**
þerscan, *to thresh*	**þærsc**	**þurscon**	**þorscen**
frignan, *to ask*	**frægn**	**frugnon**	**frugnen**
murnan, *to mourn*	**mearn**	**murnon**	
spurnan, *to spurn*	**spearn**	**spurnon**	**spornen**

In **bregdan** and **stregdan**, beside the forms with **g** there also occur forms with loss of **g** and lengthening of the preceding vowel, as **brēdan** (§ **80**, Note 2), **brǣd** (§ **54**, Note 2), **brūdon, brōden** (§ **106**, Note). **berstan** (OHG. **brestan**) and **þerscan** (OHG. **dreskan**) have metathesis of **r** (§ **280**), hence the absence of breaking in the present and pret. singular. The **i** in **frignan** is due to the influence of the **gn**; beside **frignan** there also occurs **frīnan** (§ **96**, Note 1) to which a new pret. sing. **frān** was formed after the analogy of verbs of class I; the **n** belonged originally to the present only, and the **g** to the pret. plural and past participle; the **n** and **g** were extended to all forms of the verb, cp. Goth. **fraíhnan, frah, frēhun** for ***frēgun, fraíhans** for ***frigans**; the Goth. shows that the OE. verb originally belonged to class V and that the principal parts would regularly have been ***freohnan** (***frēonan**, § **329**, 2), ***freah**, ***frāgon** (§ **120**), ***fregen**; beside the pret. pl. **frugnon** there also occur **frungon** with metathesis of **gn**, and **frūnon** with loss of **g**; and beside the pp. **frugnen** there also occur **frūnen** with loss of **g**, and **frognen**. **murnan** and **spurnan** (also **spornan**) are properly aorist presents (§ **472**).

Class IV.

§ **503**. The verbs of this class belong to the fourth ablaut-series (§ **226**), which includes the strong verbs whose stems end in a single liquid or nasal. They have **e** in the present, **æ** in the first and third pers. sing. of the preterite, **ǣ** in the pret. plural, and **o** in the past participle, thus:

	beran, *to bear*	**bær**	**bǣron**	**boren**
Goth.	**baíran**	**bar**	**bērun**	**baúrans**

And similarly **cwelan**, *to die*; **helan**, *to conceal*; **stelan**, *to steal*; **teran**, *to tear*; **þweran**, *to stir*. **scieran** (§ **91**), *to shear*, **scear** (§ **72**), **scēaron** (§ **124**), **scoren**.

§ **504.**

cuman, *to come*	**c(w)ōm**	**c(w)ōmon**	**cumen (cymen)**
niman, *to take*	**nōm**	**nōmon**	**numen**

From the regular forms of the second and third pers. sing. pres. indic. **cym(e)st, cym(e)þ,** the **y** was often extended to other forms of the pres., especially to the pres. subjunctive as **cyme** beside **cume; cuman** is an aorist present (§ **472**) from older ***kwoman** with regular loss of **w** before **u** (§§ **109, 266**), after the analogy of which it was often dropped in the preterite; **c(w)ōm** for ***cwam, *cwom,** was a new formation from the plural where **ō** was regular (§ **121**); **cumen** from older ***kwomen;** on **cymen,** see § **442. niman** from older ***neman** (§ **81**); **nōm** was a new formation from the plural which regularly had **ō** (§ **121**); beside **nōm, nōmon** there also occur the new formations **nam, nāmon; numen** from older ***nomen** (§ **109**).

Class V.

§ **505.** The verbs of this class belong to the fifth ablaut-series (§ **226**), which includes the strong verbs whose stems end in a single consonant other than a liquid or a nasal. They have **e** in the present, **æ** in the first and third pers. sing. of the preterite, and **e** in the past participle, thus:

metan, *to measure*	**mæt**	**mǣton**	**meten**
Goth. **mitan**	**mat**	**mētun**	**mitans**

And similarly **brecan** (pp. **brocen** after the analogy of class IV), *to break*; **cnedan,** *to knead*; **drepan** (pp. also **dropen** after the analogy of class IV); **screpan,** *to scrape*; **sprecan,** late OE. **specan,** *to speak*; **swefan,** *to sleep*; **tredan,** *to tread*; **wefan,** *to weave*; **wegan** (pret. pl. **wǣgon** beside **wāgon,** see § **120**), *to carry*; **wrecan,** *to avenge.* **giefan** (§ **91**), *to give,* **geaf** (§ **72**), **gēafon** (§ **124**), **giefen;** and similarly **forgietan,** *to forget.* **etan,** *to eat,* and **fretan** (Goth. **fra-itan,** pret. sing. **frēt**), *to devour,* had **ǣ** in the